

Navigating Emerging Trends for the Economic Development of Second-life EV Batteries

Conrad Nichols – Senior Technology Analyst, IDTechEx



IDTechEx

Originally Broadcast January 2025

IDTechEx Provides Clarity on Technology Innovation

Since 1999 IDTechEx has provided independent market research, consultancy and subscriptions on emerging technology to clients in over 80 countries.

- Technology assessment
- Technology scouting
- Company profiling
- Market sizing
- Market forecasts
- Strategic advice



Reports | Subscriptions | Consulting | Journals | Webinars

How IDTechEx Helps Its Customers

Supporting you at each crucial decision making step



IDTechEx Subscriptions

IDTechEx data at your command:

- Research reports
- Company profiles
- Technology analysis
- Forecasts
- Event highlights
- Research Summaries
- Company slideshows
- Analyst access time, briefings & strategic advisory sessions

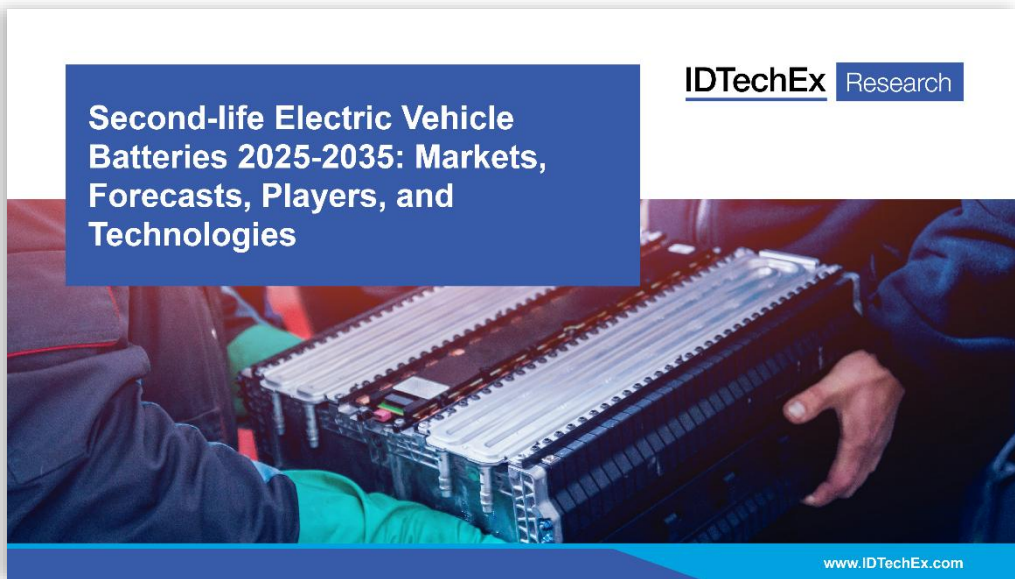
www.IDTechEx.com/Subscriptions



Our extensive knowledgebase & analysts work to support your business growth

Second-life Electric Vehicle Batteries 2025-2035: Markets, Forecasts, Players, and Technologies

10-year forecasts: second-life EV batteries & retired EV battery availability. Analyses: second-life battery technologies, markets, repurposer & end-of-life diagnostics players, regulations, repurposing costs & techno-economic analysis vs first-life Li-ion BESS.



www.IDTechEx.com/SecondLife

For full details and lists of available reports, please visit

www.IDTechEx.com

Sample pages are available for all IDTechEx reports

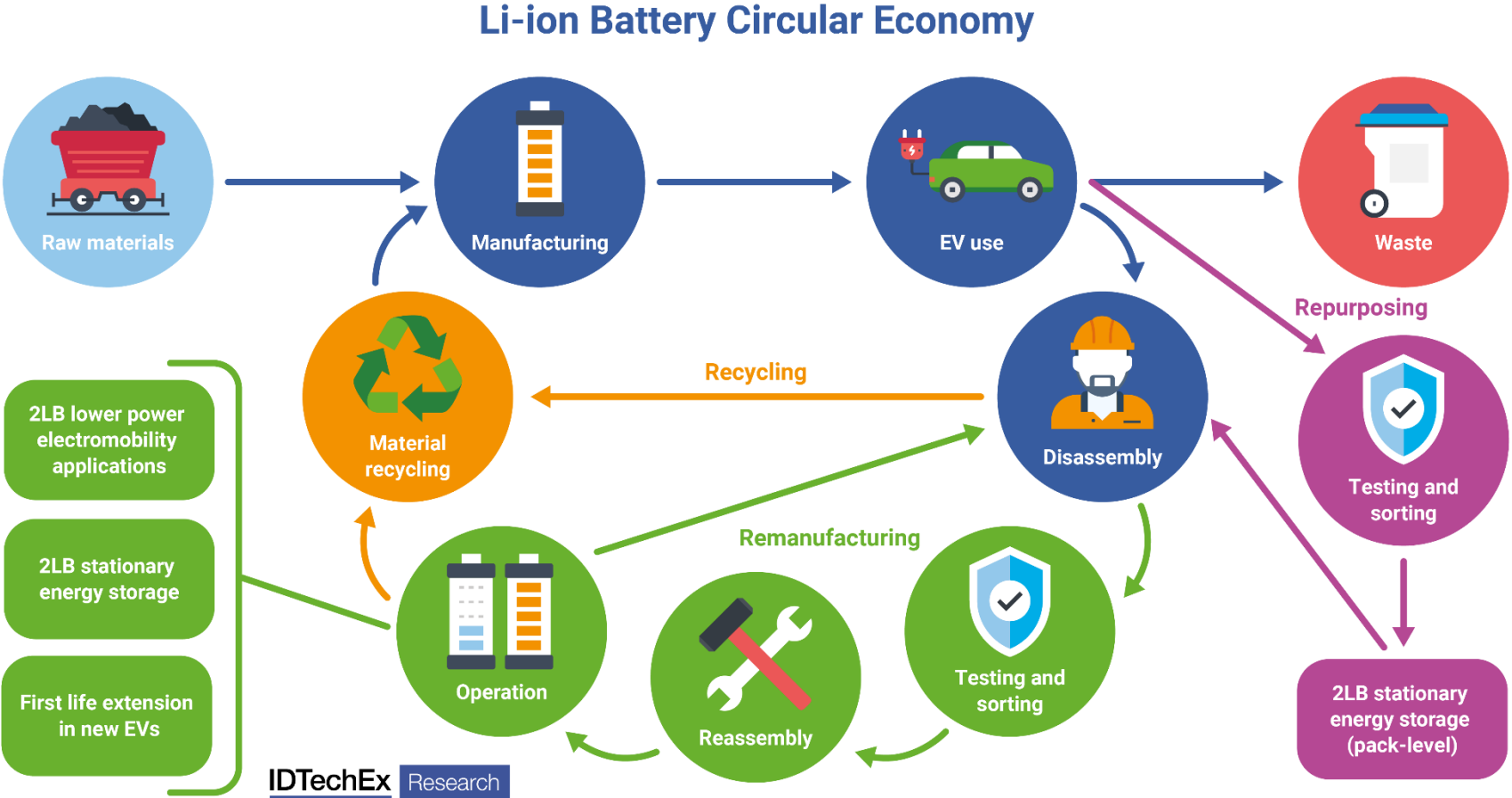
Webinar Agenda:

- Second-life EV Battery Market, Technology and Player Overview with Introduction to Policies / Regulations
- Cost Bottlenecks in the Repurposing Process
- Trends to Impact Repurposing Costs
- IDTechEx outlook

Second-life EV Battery Market, Technology and Player Overview

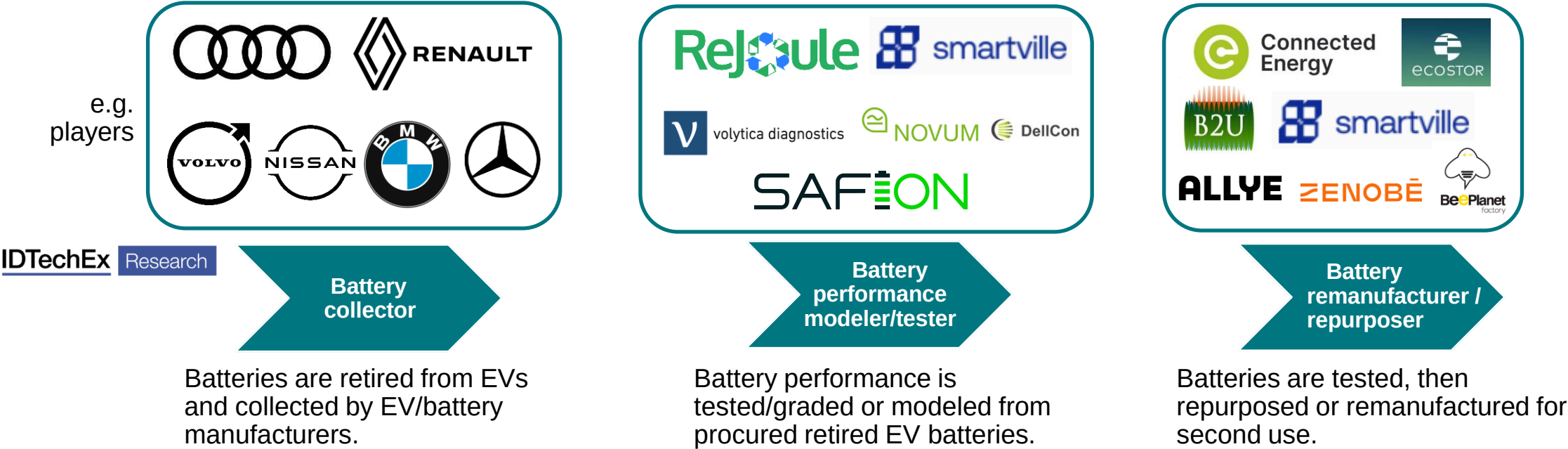


Introduction to Li-ion Battery Circular Economy

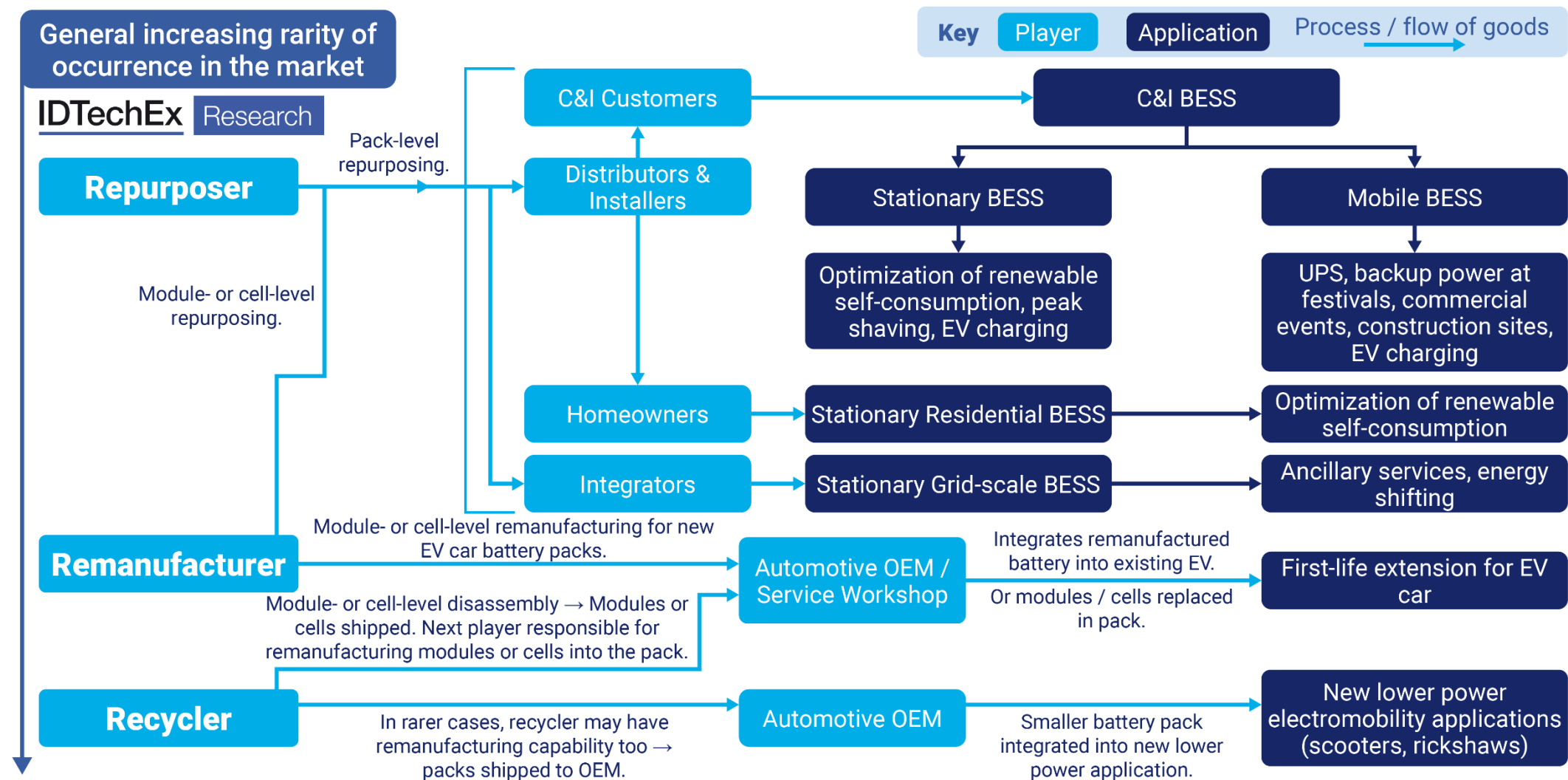


Note: 2LB = second life battery

Key Players in the Battery Second-life Value Chain



Second-life Battery Applications and Supply Chain Overview



Second-life Repurposers and Remanufacturers by HQ

European Players



US Players



South African Player



IDTechEx Research

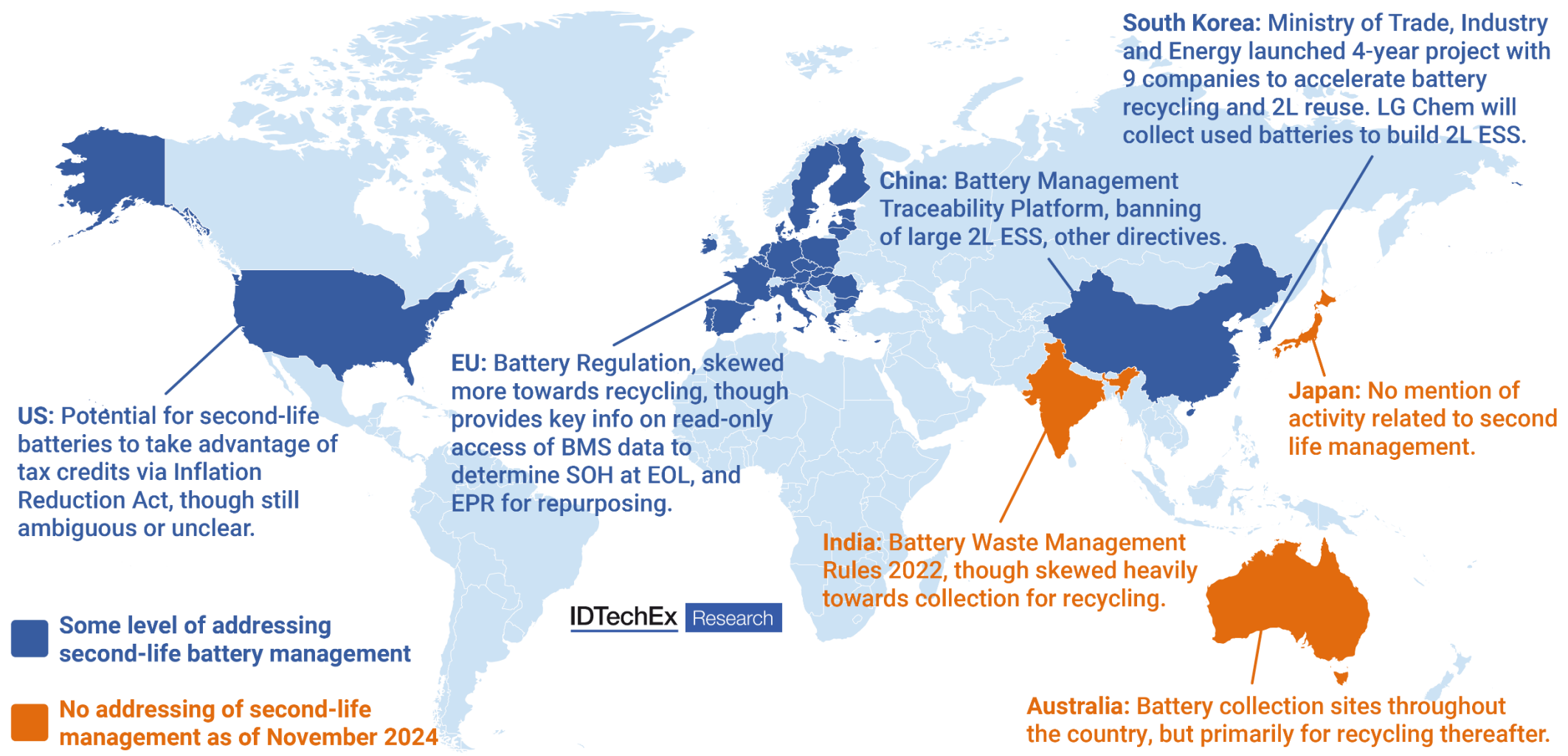
South Africa

US
5

Europe
20

Key Repurposers and Remanufacturers by Region

Global Second-life EV Battery Regulatory Landscape



Influence of EU Battery Regulation

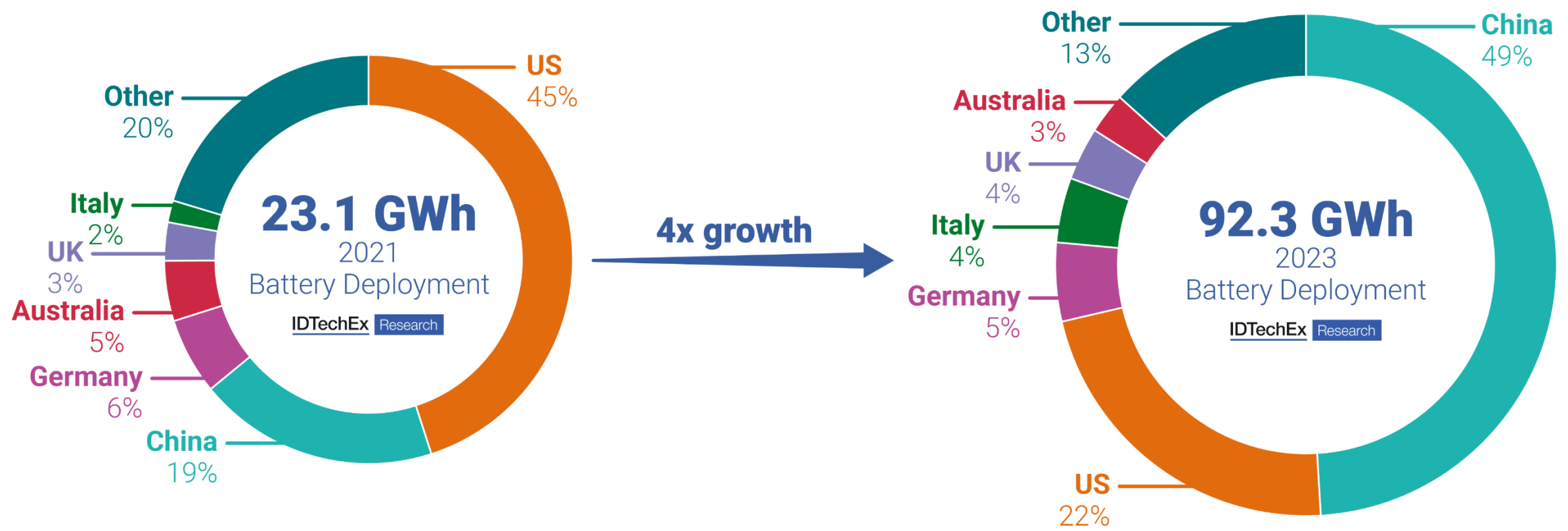
Target type	Targets		IDTechEx Research
Collection rate (LMT batteries)	By 2029	By 2032	
	51%	61%	
Collection rate (portable batteries)	By 2028	By 2031	
	63%	73%	
Overall recycling efficiency (all Li-ion batteries)	By 2026	By 2031	
	65%	70%	
Specific materials recovery efficiency	By 2028	By 2032	
	90% cobalt	95% cobalt	
	90% nickel	95% nickel	
	90% copper	95% copper	
	50% lithium	80% lithium	
Minimum recycled contents in new industrial and EV batteries	From 18 August 2031	From 18 August 2036	
	16% cobalt	26% cobalt	
	6% lithium	12% lithium	
	6% nickel	15% nickel	
	85% lead	85% lead	

Trends to Impact Costs of Second-life Battery Repurposing



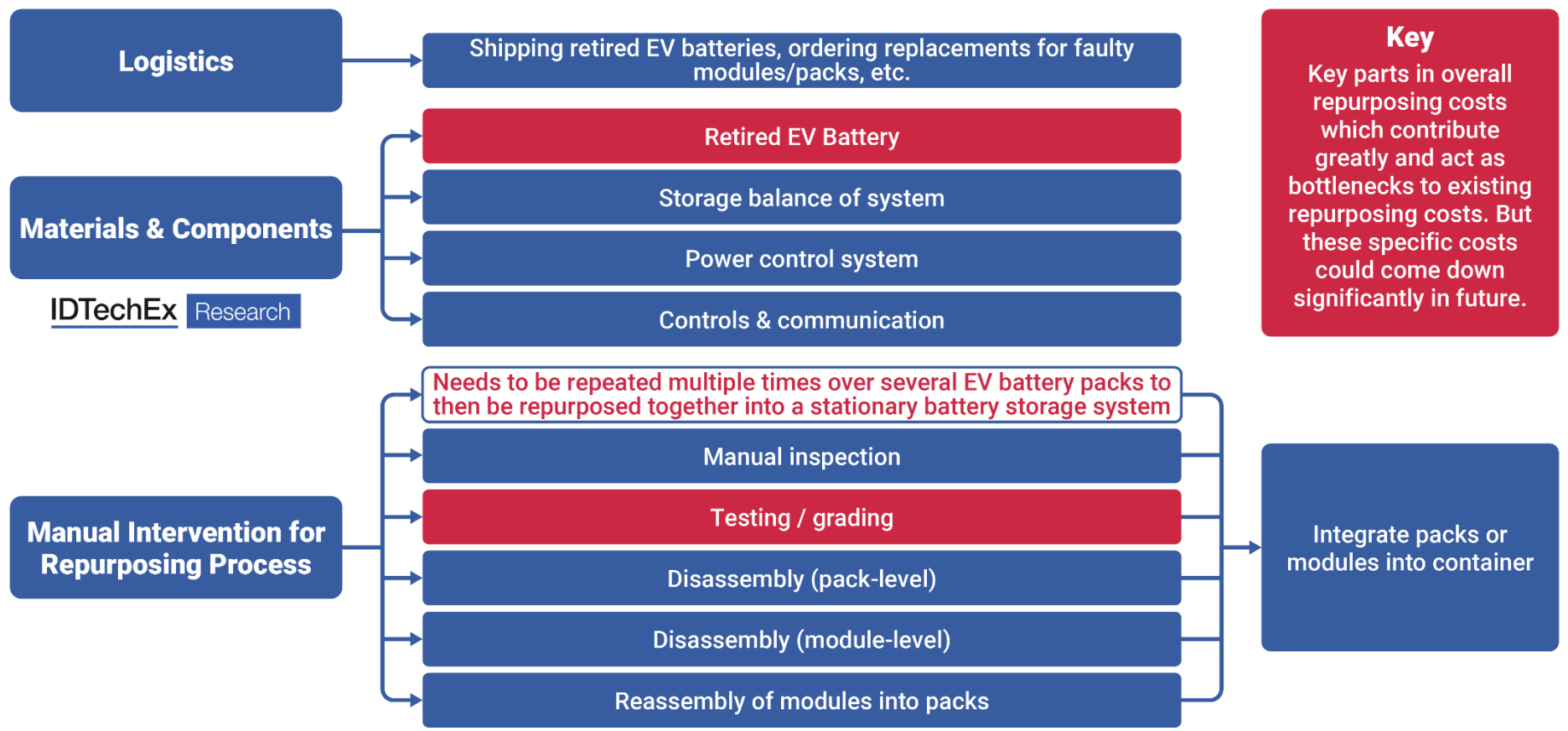
State of the First-life Li-ion BESS Market

Global deployments of first-life Li-ion BESS made annually have grown 4x in 2023 vs 2021. Some Li-ion BESS manufacturers are already reaching annual GWh-scale deployments. Prices of first-life Li-ion BESS fall into the range US\$210-350/kWh in Europe & US.



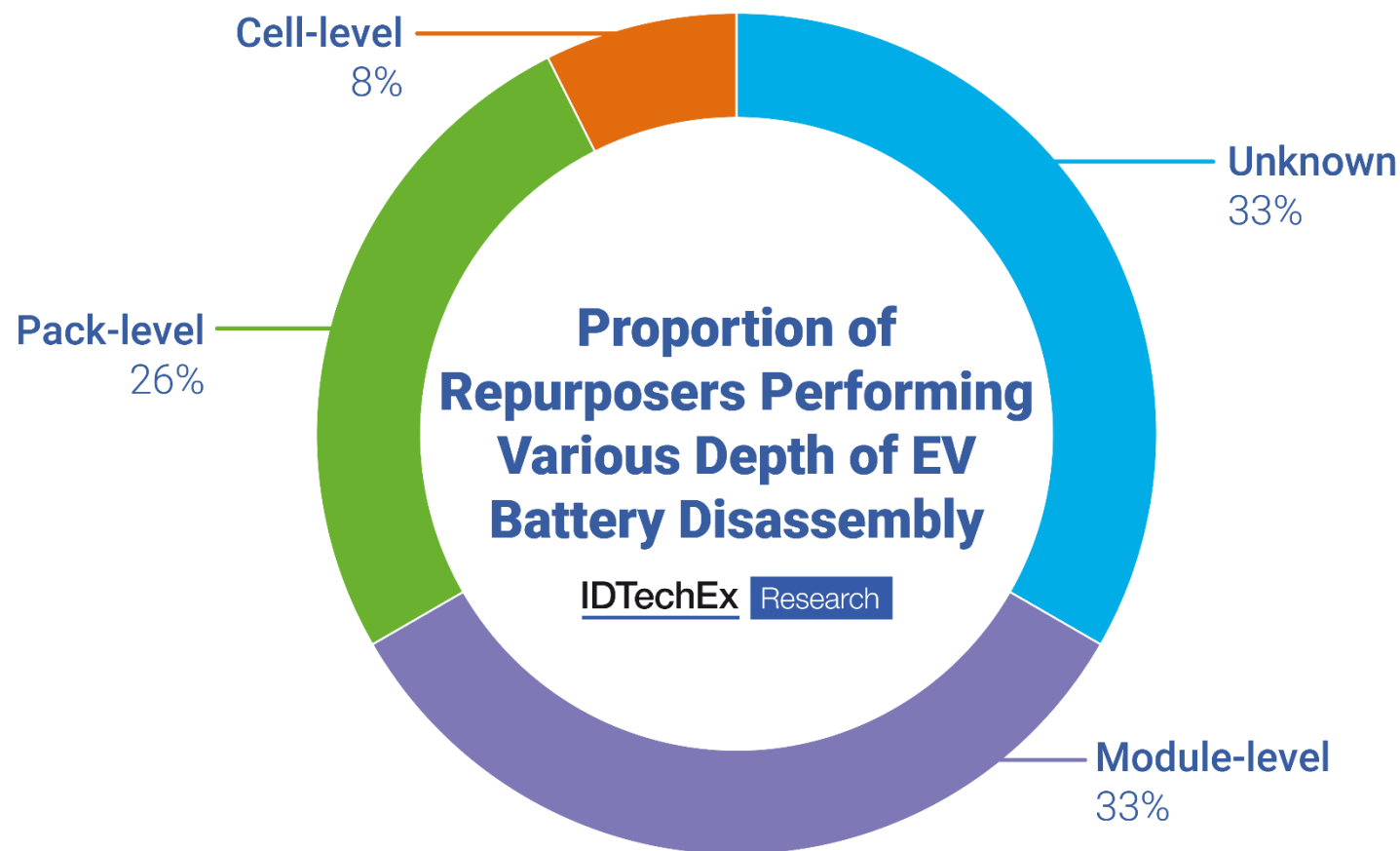
Second-life BESS Cost Comparison to First-Life Li-ion BESS and Repurposing Process Cost Bottlenecks

Second-life battery repurposing processes amount to ~US\$250/kWh for one battery energy storage system (BESS). Final second-life BESS prices are therefore higher than this, and repurposers may be struggling to compete on final system price against new, first-life Li-ion BESS (US\$210-350/kWh). This has led to only steady second-life EV battery market growth in 2023 and 2024.

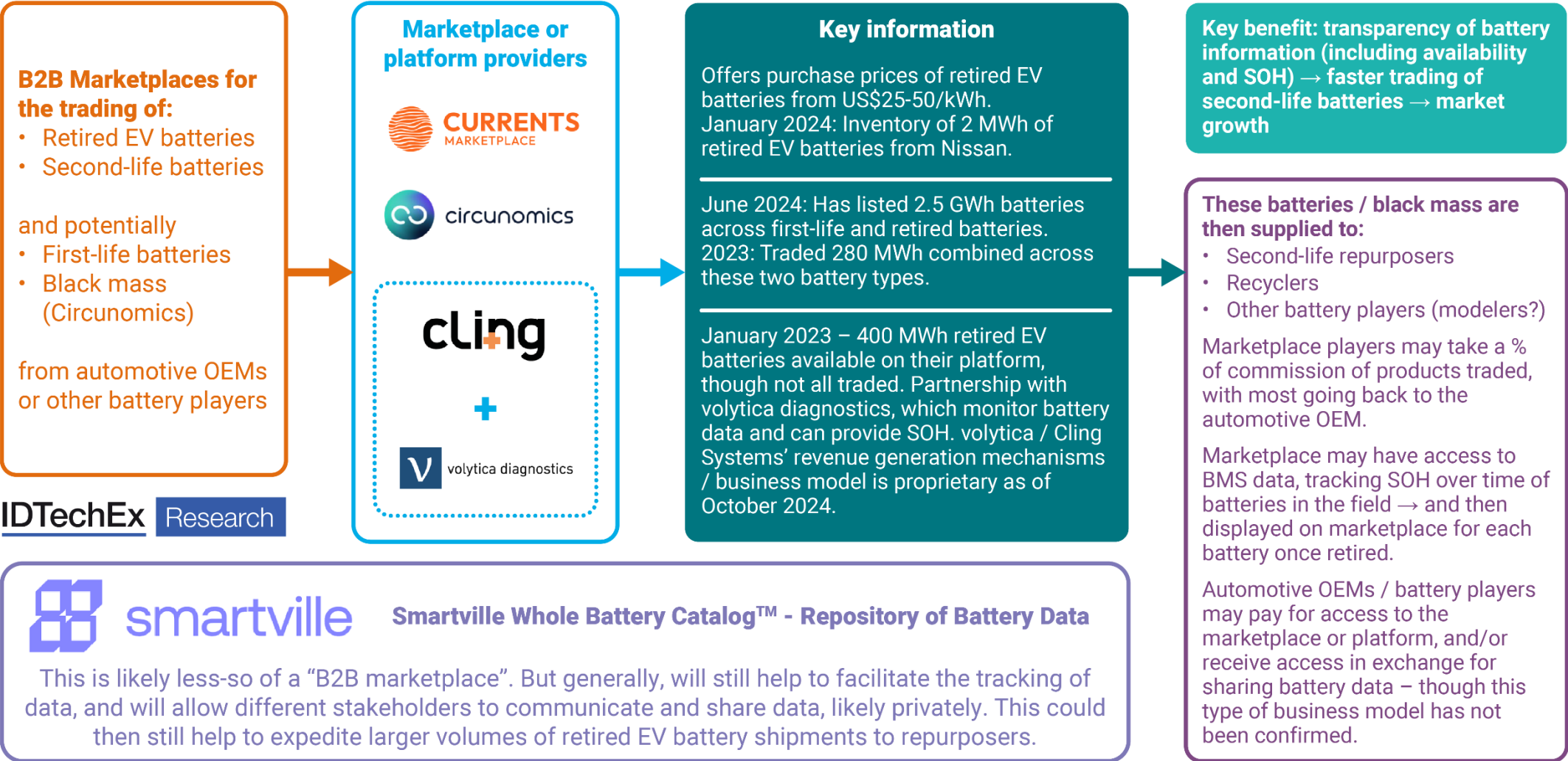


Second-life Battery Repurposers by Depth of Disassembly

Of those repurposing processes identified, module-level and pack-level repurposers dominate the market. Pack-level repurposing offers the cheapest repurposing process, though module-level repurposing could offer improved system performance.

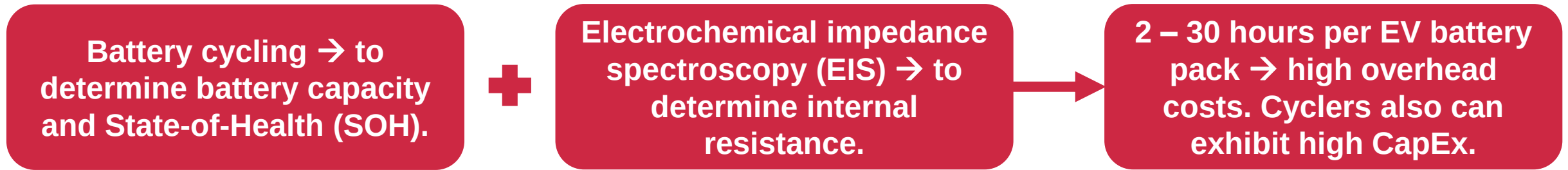


Emerging B2B Marketplaces to Benefit Second-life Battery Market

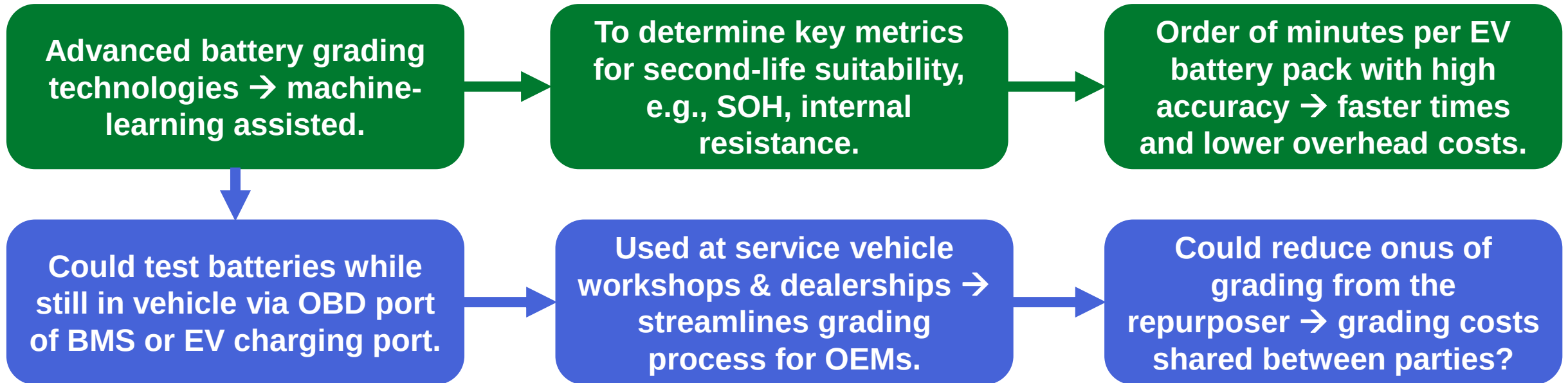


Advanced Battery Testing Technologies

Existing Situation



Future Technologies and Advantages



Second-life Battery Testing and Assessment Player Summary

Player	Technology	Location	No. employees	Speed / accuracy	Notes – acquisitions, partnerships, market activity, etc.
ReJoule	EIS at pack level, in-vehicle possible. Hybrid modelling.	California, US	15	SOH: 95% accuracy / 10 mins per pack.	Per-battery modelling, looking to expand to general chemistries.
volytica diagnostics	EIS at pack level, in-vehicle possible. Data-focused.	Dresden, Germany	30	N/A	Primarily BMS diagnostics. Partnered with Cling Systems for second-life.

+ Other key second-life battery testing and assessment players in IDTechEx’s Second-life Electric Vehicle Batteries 2025 – 2035 market report.



www.IDTechEx.com/SecondLife

For full details and lists of available reports, please visit www.IDTechEx.com

Sample pages are available for all IDTechEx reports

Semi-automated EV Battery Disassembly

IDTechEx Research

Benefit	To reduce reliance on manual labor, reducing time and costs for disassembly.
Challenges	Difficult to fully automate; e.g., disconnecting wires, unscrewing bolts. Difference in EV battery design can limit transferability of robot/cobot parameters between disassembling different EV batteries.
Current Status	Pilot projects, pilot disassembly lines, limited throughput.
Key Player / Project Examples	 

EV Battery Trends and Impacts on Second-life EV Batteries

IDTechEx Research

Trend	Impact on second-life EV batteries
1. Removal / absence of battery module (cell-to-pack or cell-to-chassis design).	Could reduce cell-level disassembly times/costs. However, more likely to be a hindrance due to use of more structural adhesives, welds, etc., which necessitate the use of solvents or heat to remove.

EV Battery Trends and Impacts on Second-life EV Batteries

IDTechEx Research

Trend	Impact on second-life EV batteries	Points to consider
1. Removal / absence of battery module (cell-to-pack or cell-to-chassis design).	Could reduce cell-level disassembly times/costs. However, more likely to be a hindrance due to use of more structural adhesives, welds, etc., which necessitate the use of solvents or heat to remove.	i) Repurposers have generally complained that these designs are more difficult, time-consuming and thus expensive to disassemble. ii) Such designs are also to the disbenefit of recyclers who disassemble packs to module-level prior to mechanical shredding for the production of black mass. iii) Repurposers and recyclers alike have called for OEMs to start designing EV batteries with ease of disassembly / improved circularity in mind.

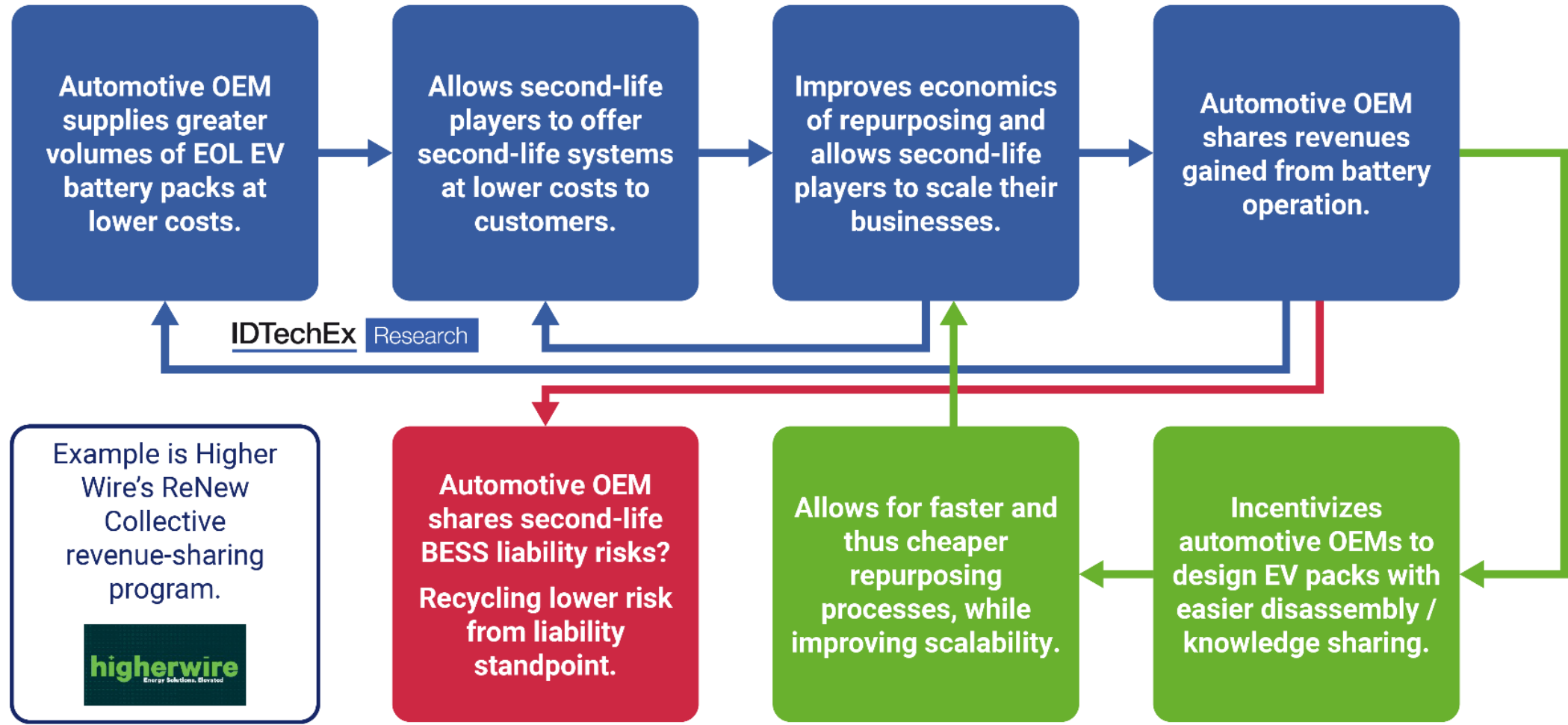
EV Battery Trends and Impacts on Second-life EV Batteries

IDTechEx Research

Trend	Impact on second-life EV batteries	Points to consider
1. Removal / absence of battery module (cell-to-pack or cell-to-chassis design).	Could reduce cell-level disassembly times/costs. However, more likely to be a hindrance due to use of more structural adhesives, welds, etc., which necessitate the use of solvents or heat to remove.	i) Repurposers have generally complained that these designs are more difficult, time-consuming and thus expensive to disassemble. ii) Such designs are also to the disbenefit of recyclers who disassemble packs to module-level prior to mechanical shredding for the production of black mass. iii) Repurposers and recyclers alike have called for OEMs to start designing EV batteries with ease of disassembly / improved circularity in mind.

+ Other key battery trends, which are discussed and their impact on second-life EV batteries or repurposing analyzed in IDTechEx’s Second-life Electric Vehicle Batteries 2025 – 2035 market report.

EV Battery Design for Circularity and Revenue Sharing Models: A Hope or Future Reality?



Access to 30+ Company Profiles: Repurposers and Second-life Battery Diagnosticians / Assessment Players

This list includes second-life EV battery repurposers, battery performance testers and modelers for second-life applications, and several Li-ion battery recyclers that are already participating, or may look to participate, in the second-life EV battery market.

1. Allye Energy
2. B2U Storage Solutions (2023)
3. B2U Storage Solutions (2022)
4. BBB Industries / TERREPOWER
5. BeePlanet Factory (2024)
6. BeePlanet Factory (2022)
7. Betteries (2024)
8. Betteries (2022)
9. Cidetec
10. Circu Li-ion
11. Circunomics
12. Connected Energy (2024)
13. Connected Energy (2023)
14. Covalion
15. Currents
16. Eatron Technologies
17. ECO STOR AS (2024)
18. ECO STOR AS (2023)
19. Ecobat
20. Exitcom Recycling
21. Higher Wire
22. Huayou Recycling
23. Liebherr-Verzahnstechnik
24. Oorja Energy
25. Reefilla
26. ReJoule (2024)
27. ReJoule (2023)
28. Relectrify
29. RePurpose Energy
30. Safion
31. SK tes
32. Smartville (2024)
33. Smartville (2023)
34. Spiers New Technologies
35. volytica diagnostics
36. Zenobē

Summary and IDTechEx Outlook

As the availability of retired EV batteries will grow over the coming decade, IDTechEx forecasts the second-life EV battery market will be valued at US\$4.2B by 2035. Market growth has remained steady, though key trends could help to reduce costs of repurposing and improve how competitive these technologies are against first-life Li-ion BESS.

Drivers

- Repurposing looks to maximize the value of the EV battery and the raw materials initially used, extend its lifetime, and delay recycling.
- Could also help to reduce the battery associated CO₂ (raw materials, transport, recycling) per kWh of total energy dispatched by the battery over the course of its lifetime.

Opportunities

- Array of opportunities to reduce repurposing costs – B2B marketplaces for lower retired EV battery costs, faster grading technologies, automated battery disassembly, and more.
- Market will grow more significantly as availability of retired EV batteries increases.
- Potential for revenue sharing opportunities and for repurposers to capitalize on using other business models (BSaaS, renting).

Challenges

- Reducing price of first-life Li-ion BESS has made it increasingly difficult for second-life repurposers to offer their technologies at competitive prices.
- Lack of policies or regulations that incentivize or encourage repurposing, with more of a focus in key regions being on recycling and recovering critical raw materials.
- Lack of standardized EV battery design and cell-to-pack designs can complicate repurposing processes and add to costs.



Second-life Electric Vehicle Batteries 2025 – 2035: Markets, Forecasts, Players, and Technologies

www.IDTechEx.com/SecondLife

Sample pages are available for all IDTechEx reports

Contact IDTechEx

Founded in 1999, IDTechEx offers trusted independent research and intelligence on emerging technologies and their market opportunities.

We help our clients to understand new technologies, their supply chains, market requirements, opportunities and forecasts.



Connect with IDTechEx to explore how we can support your business:

research@IDTechEx.com

www.IDTechEx.com

Contents copyright © ID TECHEX LIMITED, IDTechEx, Inc., IDTechEx K.K. and IDTechEx GmbH (as applicable) (“IDTechEx”) 2025, unless indicated otherwise. All rights reserved. Nothing in this document is intended to amount to advice of any kind, including investment advice, on which you should rely. IDTechEx makes no representations or warranties concerning the accuracy of the contents and shall have no liability of any kind for any use of, or reliance on, the contents, or conclusions drawn from it, by any party.